The AI Interview Cheat Sheet

Most AI training platforms, including micro1 and Mercor, start with a short video interview run by an AI. Here's what to expect, what gets scored, and how to give yourself the best chance.

1 What to expect

- **About 20–30 minutes**, on video, with your camera on.
- **An AI interviewer asks the questions.** micro1's is called Zara.
- **Questions are built from your CV** and the role you applied for.
- Some roles add a **skills test**, such as coding, writing or a subject quiz.
- **What's scored:** how clearly you explain things, how you reason, and what you really know.
- **Use a laptop or desktop.** Some platforms don't allow phones.
- **Replies often take 2–6 weeks.** You may not get a formal "no".
- Passing puts you in a **talent pool**. Work comes when a project fits you.

2 Before you start

- [ ] **Tailor your CV to the role.** The questions come from it, so lead with relevant skills, studies and examples.
- [ ] **Test your camera, mic and internet.** Close other apps and tabs, and plug your laptop in.
- [ ] **Quiet room, good light in front of you** (not behind), plain background.
- [ ] **Prepare 3 short stories** from your work or studies that show a problem you solved, something you're proud of, and a mistake you learned from.
- [ ] **Have water nearby** and give yourself 10 minutes to settle before you start.

3 Answer with STAR

S
Situation: set the scene in one sentence.

T
Task: what you needed to do.

A
Action: what *you* did, step by step.

R
Result: what happened, with a number if you can.

The biggest tip: think out loud. AI interviews score your reasoning, not just the final answer. Say how you're approaching the question ("First I'd check..., then...") rather than going quiet and giving a one-line answer.

4 Questions you're likely to get

"Tell me about yourself and your background in [field]."
Keep it to 60–90 seconds: what you do, your strongest skills, and why this role fits.

"Walk me through a time you solved a difficult problem."
Use STAR. Pick a real example with a clear result.

"How would you explain [a topic in your field] to a beginner?"
They're testing clarity. Use a simple example or comparison.

"Here's an answer an AI gave. What's wrong with it?"
Look for factual errors, missing steps, unclear wording and safety issues. Say why each one matters.

"How do you make sure your work is accurate?"
Mention checking sources, re-reading, and following the guidelines exactly.

5 10 quick tips

1. Look at the camera, not your own face on screen.
2. Answers of 1–2 minutes are usually right.
3. Be specific: numbers, tools, results.
4. Don't read from a script. It shows.
5. If you're unsure what's being asked, say how you understand the question, then answer.
6. Be honest about what you don't know, then say how you'd find out.
7. Speak a little slower than normal.
8. Match the role's language: if it says "evaluate" or "reasoning", use those words.
9. If something freezes, carry on calmly and contact support afterwards.
10. Apply to more than one platform while you wait.

6 Stay safe

- **Real platforms never charge you** to apply, interview, train or "unlock" work.
- **Only apply on the platform's own website.** Be wary of anyone who messages you first on WhatsApp or Telegram.
- **Only share ID** through the platform's own verification step.

Ready to apply?
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Based on platforms' published information and contributors' reported experience, November 2026. Processes change, so always follow each platform's own instructions.